Startup ecosystem delivers remarkable results

Under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Uttar Pradesh has taken a major leap in innovation, entrepreneurship and employment generation, emerging as the third-largest startup ecosystem in the country.

- Over the past year, nearly 5,000 new startups have commenced operations in the state, taking the total number of startups to over 21,000. Among these, more than 9,000 startups are led by women, promoting gender diversity in entrepreneurship.

- According to official data, by December 2024, the number of startups registered with the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) in Uttar Pradesh stood at around 16,000, which increased to 21,559 by December 2025. Of these, 18,568 startups are recognised under Startup India.

- The number of startups registered under 'StartInUP' stands at 2,991, while the Startup Incubation and Innovation Centre (SIIC) at IIT Kanpur hosts 521 startups. This growth is not limited to numbers alone; the state has also recorded a strong presence in terms of quality, investment and employment generation.

- Policy-driven governance, ease of doing business, and digital processes have enabled startups to scale rapidly. Clear policies, robust infrastructure and a youth-centric approach have positioned Uttar Pradesh as a trusted destination for investors and entrepreneurs.

- The startup ecosystem has not been confined to large cities alone. Startup activity is now active across all 75 districts of the state. Earlier, startup hubs were limited to cities such as Noida, Ghaziabad, Lucknow and Kanpur, but they are now expanding rapidly into smaller towns as well.

- Alongside urban centres, agritech, food processing, handloom, dairy and local service-based startups have emerged in Bundelkhand, Purvanchal and the Terai regions, directly benefiting both urban and rural economies and creating new local employment opportunities.

- Initiatives such as the Chief Minister Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan, women startup promotion schemes, and easy access to finance have encouraged women to pursue self-employment with confidence. Through startups, women are not only achieving economic empowerment but are also assuming leadership roles in society.

- To provide a strong foundation for startups, the state has 76 incubators and 7 Centres of Excellence in operation. Dedicated Centres of Excellence have been established in sectors such as IT, electronics, healthtech, agritech and green energy, providing institutional support to innovation.

generation at the local level, while positioning Uttar Pradesh as a future-ready manufacturing destination.

Promoting investment through Global Capability Centres

In the same sequence, the government is also focusing on service-based sectors that generate high-skill employment. In a Cabinet meeting chaired by the Chief Minister, approval was granted to the Rules, 2025 for the effective implementation of the Uttar Pradesh Global Capability Centre (GCC) Policy 2024. With the enforcement of these rules, the state is expected to attract global investment, high-value services, and large-scale employment opportunities.

By designating Invest UP as the nodal agency, procedures for investors will become even more streamlined. Under the GCC Policy, Indian and foreign companies will be able to establish captive units in Uttar Pradesh to handle strategic functions such as IT, research and development, finance, HR, design, engineering, analytics, and knowledge services.

The fact that 21 companies have already begun investment during the current financial year highlights the potential of this policy. To attract GCC units, a comprehensive incentive framework has been put in place. From front-end land subsidies and stamp duty exemptions to capital and interest subsidies, opex, payroll and recruitment subsidies, EPF reimbursement, and skill development and research incentives, the government has created support mechanisms at almost every level.

In addition, technical assistance, industry linkages, regulatory facilitation and fast-track disposal of applications have together created a reliable and investor-friendly environment.

Growing employment through industrial progress

From the Ashok Leyland plant
Direct and indirect
Employment
3000+
Skill development
Every year
10,000 youth

State-level employment
Investment-led employment
60 lakh+

Industrial registration and employment
Registered factories
30,219
Total employment generation
3 crore 63 lakh

Nivesh Sarathi Portal Potential employment from every signed MoU
Over 90 lakh